

Absolutely — **green** is a strong target because your passage contains the fixed expression:

> “She is the kind of person who seems to have a real **green thumb**.”

Here **green** does **not** refer literally to colour. The phrase means that your aunt seems naturally skilled at growing and caring for plants.

Word family: **green** / greener / greenest / greenery / greenness / greenish / evergreen / greenwashing

Base word: green

Comparative: greener

Superlative: greenest

Related forms: greenery, greenness, greenish

Useful lexical extensions: evergreen, greenwashing

Useful compounds / expressions: green thumb, green light, go green, green energy, green space, green card, green room, green belt, greens

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞) / verb-related modern uses (相關動詞用法)

The main modern semantic ideas are:

1. the colour green;
2. covered with vegetation / full of plant life;
3. environmentally friendly;
4. young, fresh, or not fully mature;
5. inexperienced or naïve;
6. figurative expressions such as **green with envy**;
7. noun uses such as grassy areas, golf greens, and leafy vegetables.

Meaning in your passage: **green thumb** = natural skill at growing plants — 很會種植物；有園藝天分

Your sentence:

> “She is the kind of person who seems to have a real **green thumb**.”

Green thumb is a fixed expression meaning:

> **a natural or well-developed ability to grow plants successfully and keep them healthy.**

繁體中文：

很擅長種植、照顧植物，似乎天生有園藝天分

Natural translation:

> “She seems to have a real green thumb.”

「她看起來真的**很有種植物的天分 / 很有園藝天分**。」

So:

> **have a green thumb = 很會種植物；有園藝天分**

American English commonly uses **green thumb**.

British English also commonly has:

> **green fingers**

= 園藝天分

1. **green = colour (顏色) — 綠色的**

The basic literal meaning.

Practice 1

> “The leaves are bright **green**.”

「那些葉子呈鮮**綠色**。」

Practice 2

> “She painted the door **green**.”

「她把門漆成了**綠色**。」

green = 顏色介乎黃色與藍色之間、典型像青草 / 葉子的顏色

2. **green = covered with grass/plants (環境) — 青翠的；綠意盎然的**

A common extension from colour.

Practice 3

> “The valley stays **green** throughout the spring.”

「山谷整個春天都保持**青翠翠綠**。」

Practice 4

> “They live in a very **green** area.”

「他們住在一個**綠意盎然、植物很多的地區**。」

green — landscape = 因大量草木、植被生長而呈現青翠、有植物覆蓋的狀態

This is related to colour, but learners often need the contextual Chinese:

> **青翠 / 綠意盎然**

rather than simply 「綠色的」.

3. **green = environmentally friendly (環保)** — 環保的；對環境較友善的

A major modern meaning.

Practice 5

> “The company is investing in **green technology**.”

「公司正在投資**環保科技**。」

Practice 6

> “Many cities are trying to become **greener**.”

「很多城市正努力變得**更環保、更重視可持續發展**。」

green — environmental = 對自然環境造成較少傷害，或有助於節能、減排、保護資源的

Common:

- * green technology
- * green energy
- * green building
- * green transport
- * green economy

4. **go green = adopt environmentally friendly practices — 採取環保做法；走向綠色生活**

A highly useful fixed expression.

Practice 7

> “The school is trying to **go green** by reducing waste.”

「學校正透過減少廢物來**推行更環保的做法**。」

Practice 8

> “More businesses are going green.”

「越來越多企業正**轉向環保營運方式**。」

****go green = 開始採用對環境較友善、節能或可持續的做法****

This is a fixed modern expression rather than another unrelated meaning of bare **green**.

5. **green + fruit/vegetable (未成熟) — 未熟的；青的**

A genuinely important literal meaning.

Practice 9

> “The tomatoes are still **green**.”

「那些番茄仍然**未熟 / 還是青的**。」

Practice 10

> “Don’t pick the fruit while it is still green.”

「水果還**未成熟**時不要摘下來。」

****green — fruit = 尚未成熟，通常仍保留較青綠的顏色或未成熟特徵****

Important:

> green tomato

may mean literally green-coloured or specifically **unripe**, depending on context.

6. **green** = fresh / not dried or seasoned (木材 / 植物) — 新鮮未乾的 ; 未乾燥處理的

A useful material/agricultural sense.

Practice 11

> “The firewood was too **green** to burn properly.”

「那些柴木太**新鮮未乾 / 含水量太高**，很難正常燃燒。」

Practice 12

> “Green wood can change shape as it dries.”

「**未乾燥處理的木材**在乾燥過程中可能變形。」

green — material = 剛砍下 / 剛生長、仍含較多水分，尚未乾燥或熟成的

This is especially common with:

> green wood / green timber

7. **green** = inexperienced / new to something — 經驗不足的 ; 生手的

A major figurative meaning.

Practice 13

> “The new employee is still quite **green**.”

「那名新員工仍然很**缺乏經驗 / 很生手**。」

Practice 14

> “He was talented but **green** when he first became a manager.”

「他很有才華，但剛當經理時仍然**經驗不足**。」

green — person = 剛接觸某工作 / 領域，缺乏實際經驗，仍不成熟

This often has a mildly informal tone.

8. **green = naïve / unsophisticated (世故程度) — 天真無經驗的 ; 不懂世故的**

Closely related to #7, but the emphasis shifts from professional experience to worldly judgment.

Practice 15

> “He was too **green** to realise that the offer was suspicious.”

「他太**天真、缺乏世故經驗**，沒有察覺那個提議可疑。」

Practice 16

> “She was young and green when she first moved to the city.”

「她剛搬到城市時年輕而且**很不懂世故**。」

green = 因缺乏人生 / 社會經驗而顯得天真、不成熟

Because this and #7 share the same underlying idea of **lack of maturity/experience**, I would regard them as contextual branches of one broad figurative sense rather than unrelated meanings.

9. **green with envy (嫉妒) — 嫉妒得不得了 ; 眼紅**

A very common idiom.

Practice 17

> “She was **green with envy** when she saw her friend’s garden.”

「她看到朋友的花園時**羨慕嫉妒得不得了 / 非常眼紅**。」

Practice 18

> “His colleagues were green with envy after he won the prize.”

「他得獎後，同事們都**羨慕得眼紅**。」

green with envy = 非常嫉妒 / 羨慕某人所擁有的東西

Do not interpret the colour literally.

10. **green = pale/sick-looking (臉色) — 臉色發青；看起來想吐的**

A useful conversational meaning.

Practice 19

> “He looked slightly **green** after the boat ride.”

「坐船後，他看起來**臉色發青、像是想吐**。」

Practice 20

> “You look a bit green. Are you feeling sick?”

「你看起來有點**臉色發青 / 不舒服**，是不是想吐？」

green — appearance = 因噁心、不適等令臉色看起來異常蒼白 / 發青

Common in informal English.

11. **green light (交通) — 綠燈；可以通行的訊號**

Practice 21

> “Wait until the light turns **green**.”

「等到交通燈變成**綠燈**才走。」

Practice 22

> “The cars moved when the green light appeared.”

「**綠燈**亮起後，汽車開始前進。」

green light — literal = 交通訊號中表示可以前進 / 通行的綠色燈號

12. **green light (比喻) — 批准；許可；放行**

A very common figurative extension.

Practice 23

> “The project received the **green light**.”

「這個項目獲得了**批准 / 正式放行**。」

Practice 24

> “Management gave us the green light to begin.”

「管理層**批准我們開始進行**。」

green light — figurative = 正式批准某項計劃 / 行動開始進行的許可

Underlying metaphor:

> green traffic light → permission to proceed

13. **green space** (城市 / 環境) — 綠地 ; 綠化空間

Practice 25

> “The neighbourhood has plenty of **green space**.”

「這個社區有很多**綠地 / 綠化空間**。」

Practice 26

> “Parks provide valuable green space in crowded cities.”

「公園為擁擠城市提供寶貴的**綠化空間**。」

green space = 城市 / 社區中由草地、樹木、植物等構成的開放自然空間

14. **the green** = grassy area (草地) — 草坪 ; 公共草地

Now **green** is a noun.

Practice 27

> “Children were playing on the village **green**.”

「孩子們正在村中的**公共草地**上玩耍。」

Practice 28

> “People gathered on the green for the summer event.”

「人們聚集在**草坪 / 公共草地**參加夏日活動。」

a/the green = 一片主要由青草覆蓋的公共開放地

Especially common in:

> village green

15. **green = golf putting area (高爾夫球) — 果嶺**

A distinct sports noun meaning.

Practice 29

> “Her ball landed on the **green**.”

「她的球落在**果嶺**上。」

Practice 30

> “The golfer carefully read the green before putting.”

「高爾夫球手推桿前仔細判斷**果嶺的坡度和狀況**。」

green — golf = 球洞周圍剪得非常短、供球員推桿的草地區域

16. **greens (固定複數) — 綠葉蔬菜 ; 青菜**

A useful lexicalized plural.

Practice 31

> “You should eat more leafy **greens**.”

「你應該多吃**綠葉蔬菜 / 青菜**。」

Practice 32

> “The meal came with rice and fresh greens.”

「這頓飯配有白飯和新鮮**青菜**。」

greens = 供食用的綠葉蔬菜

Examples:

* spinach

* kale

* lettuce-type leafy vegetables

This is not simply “many green colours.”

17. **greenery = green plants/foilage (植物) — 綠色植物；綠葉；綠意**

A useful related noun.

Practice 33

> “The balcony was filled with **greenery**.”

「露台上充滿了**綠色植物 / 綠意**。」

Practice 34

> “The café uses greenery to create a relaxing atmosphere.”

「咖啡店利用**綠色植物**營造放鬆的氣氛。」

greenery = 植物、樹葉和綠色植被作為整體所形成的景象

18. **greenness = quality/state of being green — 綠色程度；青翠；環保程度**

Practice 35

> “The rain restored the **greenness** of the hills.”

「雨水讓山坡重新恢復**青翠綠意**。」

Practice 36

> “The report compares the greenness of different buildings.”

「報告比較不同建築物的**環保程度**。」

greenness = 呈綠色 / 青翠的程度，或比喻某事物的環保程度

The Chinese changes naturally by context.

19. **greenish = somewhat green — 帶綠色的；偏綠的**

Practice 37

> “The water had a **greenish** colour.”

「水呈現**偏綠 / 帶綠色**的色調。」

Practice 38

> “The leaves turned greenish-yellow.”

「葉子變成**帶綠的黃色 / 黃綠色**。」

greenish = 顏色有些接近綠色，但不是純正明顯的綠色

20. **evergreen = plant that stays green throughout the year — 常綠植物；常綠的**

A useful lexical family extension.

Practice 39

> “Pine trees are **evergreen**.”

「松樹是**常綠植物 / 常綠的**。」

Practice 40

> “They planted several evergreen trees around the garden.”

「他們在花園四周種了幾棵**常綠樹**。」

****evergreen — literal = 葉子全年保持綠色，不會在同一季節全部脫落的植物****

21. ****evergreen = continually popular/relevant (比喻) — 長青的；長久不衰的****

A useful figurative extension.

Practice 41

> “The song became an ****evergreen classic****.”

「這首歌成為一首****歷久不衰的經典作品****。」

Practice 42

> “It is an evergreen topic in education.”

「這是教育界一個****長期都具有討論價值的題目****。」

****evergreen — figurative = 長時間保持受歡迎、重要或相關，不容易過時的****

Very common in media/content:

> evergreen content

> = 長期有效、不易過時的內容

22. ****greenwashing = misleading environmental presentation — 漂綠；假環保宣傳****

A very useful modern family extension.

Practice 43

> “Consumers accused the company of ****greenwashing****.”

「消費者指責該公司進行****漂綠 / 假環保宣傳****。」

Practice 44

> “Greenwashing can make a product appear more environmentally friendly than it really is.”

「****漂綠****會令產品看起來比實際情況更環保。」

****greenwashing = 透過宣傳、標籤或形象營造，把公司 / 產品包裝得比實際更環保****

This is a separate modern lexical extension, not a meaning of bare ****green**** itself.

23. ****green card (美國) — 美國永久居民卡****

A common opaque compound.

Practice 45

> “She received her ****green card**** after several years.”

「幾年後，她取得了美國****永久居民卡 / 綠卡****。」

Practice 46

> “A green card allows a person to live permanently in the United States, subject to the relevant rules.”

「美國****綠卡****讓持有人在符合相關規定下永久居留。」

****green card = 美國用來證明永久居民身分的證件****

This is a lexicalized compound; ****green**** here should not be interpreted simply through its ordinary modern semantic senses.

24. ****green room (劇場 / 媒體) — 演員 / 嘉賓休息室****

Another useful non-transparent compound.

Practice 47

> “The guests waited in the ****green room**** before the interview.”

「嘉賓在訪問前於****演員 / 嘉賓休息室****等候。」

Practice 48

> “The actor returned to the green room after the performance.”

「演員表演後回到****後台休息室****。」

****green room = 劇場、電視台或演出場地中供表演者 / 嘉賓等候、休息的房間****

It does not have to be green.

25. ****green belt (城市規劃) — 綠化帶 ; 城市綠帶****

Practice 49

> “Development is restricted in the ****green belt****.”

「在****城市綠化帶 / 綠帶****內，發展受到限制。」

Practice 50

> “The green belt helps preserve open land around the city.”

「****綠化帶****有助保護城市周圍的開放土地。」

****green belt = 城市周圍受規劃保護、限制大規模建設的一圈開放 / 綠化土地****

26. ****green thumb / green fingers (園藝) — 園藝天分 ; 很會種植物****

Returning to your source expression.

Practice 51 — Original

> “She seems to have a real ****green thumb****.”

「她似乎真的****很有園藝天分 / 很會種植物****。」

Practice 52

> “My grandfather has a green thumb; almost everything he plants grows well.”

「我祖父****非常會種植物****；他種的東西幾乎都長得很好。」

Practice 53

> “I definitely don’t have a green thumb.”

「我真的****完全沒有種植物的天分****。」

****green thumb = 很擅長種植和照顧植物的能力 / 天分****

Regional note:

* ****green thumb**** — especially common in American English

* ****green fingers**** — especially common in British English

Important distinction: ****green vs environmental / eco-friendly****

****green****

common, broad, sometimes promotional.

> green technology

****environmentally friendly / eco-friendly****

more explicit:

> designed to cause less environmental harm

So:

> green product

may mean “marketed/considered environmentally friendly,” but the precise environmental benefit depends on context.

Important distinction: ****green vs sustainable****

These overlap but are not identical.

****green****

broadly environmentally friendly.

****sustainable****

able to continue long-term without exhausting resources or causing unacceptable environmental/social harm.

A product can be marketed as ****green**** without necessarily being fully ****sustainable****.

Important distinction: **green vs unripe**

For fruit:

green

may describe colour **or** immaturity.

> green apple

can simply be a green-coloured variety.

unripe

specifically means not mature enough to eat/use normally.

So context determines whether:

> green fruit

means **綠色水果** or **未成熟水果**.

Important distinction: **green vs fresh**

With wood:

green wood

= recently cut and still moist.

fresh

broader:

recently produced/gathered/not stale.

You would not normally replace:

> green timber

with:

> fresh timber

in technical wood terminology.

Important distinction: **green** vs **inexperienced**

green

informal figurative adjective.

> “He’s still green.”

inexperienced

neutral/direct.

> “He’s still inexperienced.”

Both can mean:

「他仍然缺乏經驗。」

But **green** is more figurative and conversational.

Important distinction: **green** vs **naïve**

green

often implies lack of experience.

naïve

emphasizes lack of worldly judgment, sometimes excessive trust or simplicity.

A new employee may be **green** without being particularly **naïve**.

Important distinction: **green light** — literal vs figurative

Literal

> green traffic light

= 可以通行的綠燈

Figurative

> give a project the green light

= 批准項目開始

Same phrase, metaphorical extension through the idea:

> **green = permission to proceed**

Important distinction: **green vs greenery**

green

adjective/noun referring to colour, environment, grass area, etc.

greenery

collective noun for plants/foilage.

> “The room is green.”

= 房間是綠色的。

> “The room is full of greenery.”

= 房間裡有很多綠色植物。

Important distinction: **green vs greens**

green

colour / adjective / grassy area.

greens

leafy vegetables.

> “Eat your greens.”

= 「把青菜吃掉。」

Not:

> 「吃你的綠色。」

Important distinction: **green thumb** vs **green fingers**

Same meaning, regional preference:

> **green thumb** — especially American English

> **green fingers** — especially British English

Both mean:

> **很會種植物 / 有園藝天分**

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **green — colour** = 綠色

* **green — vegetation** = 青翠 / 綠意盎然

* **green — environmental** = 環保

* **go green** = 採取環保做法

* **green — unripe** = 未成熟

* **green — fresh timber** = 未乾燥的新木材

* **green — inexperienced** = 經驗不足

* **green — naïve** = 不懂世故

* **green with envy** = 嫉妒 / 眼紅

* **green — sick-looking** = 臉色發青

* **green light — literal** = 綠燈

* **green light — figurative** = 批准 / 許可

* **green space** = 綠地

* **the green** = 公共草地

* **green — golf** = 果嶺

* **greens** = 綠葉蔬菜

* **greenery** = 綠色植物 / 綠意

* **greenness** = 青翠 / 環保程度

* **greenish** = 偏綠 / 帶綠色

* **evergreen — plant** = 常綠植物
 * **evergreen — figurative** = 長青 / 不易過時
 * **greenwashing** = 漂綠
 * **green card** = 美國永久居民卡
 * **green room** = 後台 / 嘉賓休息室
 * **green belt** = 綠化帶
 * **green thumb / green fingers** = 園藝天分

I would stop here rather than flood the family with every transparent compound containing **green**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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green — colour	與青草 / 葉子相似的綠色
green — vegetation	因大量草木生長而呈現青翠、有植物覆蓋的
green — environmental	對環境造成較少傷害或有助節能、減排、保護資源的
go green	開始採用更環保、節能或可持續的做法
green — fruit	尚未完全成熟，仍具有未成熟特徵的
green — wood	剛砍下、含水量高、尚未乾燥 / 熟成的
green — inexperienced	因剛接觸某領域而缺乏實際經驗的
green — naïve	因缺乏人生 / 社會經驗而顯得天真、不懂世故的
green with envy	對別人所擁有的東西感到非常嫉妒 / 眼紅
green — sick-looking	因噁心或不適而顯得臉色異常發青的
green light — literal	交通訊號中表示可以前進的綠色燈號
green light — figurative	正式允許某項計劃 / 行動開始進行的批准
green space	城市 / 社區中由草地、樹木等形成的自然開放空間
the green	主要由青草覆蓋的公共草地
green — golf	球洞周圍供球員推桿的短草區域；果嶺
greens	供食用的綠葉蔬菜
greenery	植物、綠葉和綠色植被形成的整體
greenish	顏色有些接近綠色但並非純綠的
evergreen — literal	葉子全年保持綠色的植物
evergreen — figurative	長期保持受歡迎、重要或相關，不容易過時的
greenwashing	把公司 / 產品宣傳得比實際更環保的誤導性形象包裝
green card	證明美國永久居民身分的證件
green room	劇場 / 媒體場所供表演者、嘉賓等待和休息的房間
green belt	城市周邊受保護、限制大規模建設的開放綠化土地
green thumb	很擅長種植和照顧植物的能力 / 園藝天分

For your original sentence

> “She is the kind of person who seems to have a real **green thumb**.”

The exact meaning is:

****green thumb = 很擅長種植和照顧植物，具有明顯的園藝天分****

So naturally:

> ****「她是那種一看就很有『綠手指』天分、很會種植物的人。」****

And the important learner warning is:

> ****green thumb** does *not* mean a literally green-coloured thumb.**

It is a fixed figurative expression for:

> ****「很會種植物 / 有園藝天分」**.**